

Mid-term

HIST-103 | The Emergence of Modern Europe

Instructor: Dr. Lindsay O'Neill

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight:	20%
Start date:	2026-08-25
Due date:	2026-10-09
Group project:	No

Overview (Assignments section)

The midterm will include ten of the identification terms (I give a definition and you give the term, just like the quizzes) and one longer essay (you will be given five prompts in advance and two will be on the exam, you pick one to address). This will be an in-class exam.

Related Mentions

- The midterm will include ten of the identification terms (I give a definition and you give the term, just like the quizzes) and one longer essay (you will be given five prompts in advance and two will be on the exam, you pick one to address). This will be an in-class exam.
- to engage with these terms. You cannot make up these quizzes, but your lowest score
- will be dropped.
- Sleep Paper -20%
- This 4 page paper will ask you to use readings on early modern sleeping patterns to
- make an argument about primary sources and/or life in early modern Europe. You
- will turn it in via your TA's Brightspace. See Brightspace for prompts.
- Witchcraft Paper - 20%
- This 4 page paper will ask you to read a number of primary sources detailing early
- modern witchcraft trials and to pick a prompt to make argument about what you read.
- You will turn it in via your TA's Brightspace. See Brightspace for prompts.
- Mid-term - 20%
- The midterm will include ten of the identification terms (I give a definition and you
- give the term, just like the quizzes) and one longer essay (you will be given five
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- PDF document
- Broken.Spears.10

- PDF document
- Oct 6-9: Midterm & Break
- Oct 6: Midterm
- Oct 8: No Class - Fall Break
- Oct 9: No Section - Fall Break
- Oct 6: Midterm
- Hist 103: Midterm Study Guide
- Midterm: October 8th, 5-6:20pm in class
- Hist 103: Midterm Study Guide
- Midterm: October 8th, 5-6:20pm in class

Prompts (pick ONE)

- be an in-class exam.
- Final Exam - 20%
- The final is the same format as the midterm - 10 identifications and one longer essay.
- This too will be an in-class exam.
- Grading Scale
- A: 100-93; A-: 92-90; B+: 89-87; B: 86-83; B-: 82-80; C+: 79-77; C: 76-73; C- 72-70
- D+: 69-67; D: 66-63; D-: 62-60; F: 59-0
- Aug 25-29: Intro & Black Death
- Aug 25: Introducing the Early Modern World
- Aug 27: The Death of the Dark Ages?: The Medieval Inheritance
- Aug 28: Readings for Section

Exam Format

- By the midterm you will have gathered 33 identifications from class lectures. We will list
- the definitions of ten terms and you will have to provide us with the term it corresponds to.
- The terms will not be provided. Be aware this segment of the exam can hurt you if you are
- not prepared because it is hard for us to give partial credit, so do know your terms.
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- the definitions of ten terms and you will have to provide us with the term it corresponds to.
- The terms will not be provided. Be aware this segment of the exam can hurt you if you are
- not prepared because it is hard for us to give partial credit, so do know your terms.
- Below you will find five essay questions, TWO of these will show up on the exam, and
- you will be expected to answer ONE. Try to incorporate knowledge you have gathered
- both from lectures and from the readings. It always looks good if you can use examples

- from the readings - you don't need to quote things, but discussing a specific person, text,
- or event helps (evidence!). You should not use information you learned elsewhere since we
- are testing you on what you learned from this class. Since you have these questions in
- advance you should take the time to consider your answers: be sure that your essay has an
- argument that you support with examples and that it is written in essay form (introduction,
- supporting paragraphs with specific evidence, conclusion). Most of these questions are
- intentionally broad. It is up to you to find a way to focus the question in an interesting way
- and find support for that.
- Could Europe in 1550 be called a "new world"? Why or why not? [You can define
- what you mean by "new world"]
- Create a character for yourself who is on their deathbed between 1450 and 1550
- and looking back on their life. What structured their life and what changes did they
- witness? What does it show us about the period? Be sure to think about where they
- were living, their gender, and what class they belonged to.
- True or False: "The 'big' events of the early modern period, like the Renaissance
- and westward expansion, were events created and experienced by male elites."
- Defend your answer.
- What changed early modern Europe more: art and ideas, war, or disease and/or
- environmental change?
- Between 1348 and 1550 what impact did the outside world have upon Europe? Did
- it affect it more than interior changes?

Full Syllabus Extract

Hist 103: Midterm Study Guide Midterm: October 8th, 5-6:20pm in class Part 1 (30%): Identifications By the midterm you will have gathered 33 identifications from class lectures. We will list the definitions of ten terms and you will have to provide us with the term it corresponds to. The terms will not be provided. Be aware this segment of the exam can hurt you if you are not prepared because it is hard for us to give partial credit, so do know your terms. Part 2 (70%): Essay

Below you will find five essay questions, TWO of these will show up on the exam, and you will be expected to answer ONE. Try to incorporate knowledge you have gathered both from lectures and from the readings. It always looks good if you can use examples from the readings - you don't need to quote things, but discussing a specific person, text, or event helps (evidence!). You should not use information you learned elsewhere since we are testing you on what you learned from this class. Since you have these questions in advance you should take the time to consider your answers: be sure that your essay has an argument that you support with examples and that it is written in essay form (introduction, supporting paragraphs with specific evidence, conclusion). Most of these questions are intentionally broad. It is up to you to find a way to focus the question in an interesting way and find support for that. Could Europe in 1550 be called a "new world"? Why or why not? [You can define what you mean by "new world"] Create a character for yourself who is on their deathbed between 1450 and 1550 and looking back on their life. What structured their life and what changes did they witness? What does it show us about the period? Be sure to think about where they were living, their gender, and what class they belonged to. True or False: "The 'big' events of the early modern period, like the Renaissance and westward expansion, were events created and experienced by male elites." Defend your answer. What changed early

modern Europe more: art and ideas, war, or disease and/or environmental change? Between 1348 and 1550 what impact did the outside world have upon Europe? Did it affect it more than interior changes?

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